



are articles on Kokoroko, an Afrobeat Jazz band; UKTIS, the Skater group of Muslim girls in Britain; and a photo story of a young Afghan girl, Fatima, a refugee aspiring to play world class women's football. Empowering images of black models with vitiligo, plus size models and trans women proudly declare their identity and their individuality. Each story celebrates their mixed cultural heritage, defying the very narrow ideals of traditional white Eurocentric beauty standards.

The key theme of each print magazine directly challenges those dominant ideologies to foreground the underrepresented (#4 'Access' celebrates pioneers pushing boundaries of acceptance; #5 'Defiant Beauty' challenges ethnocentric beauty standards; #6 'Body Movements' challenges inequalities in sports through gender, sexuality, country, etc). The online magazine publishes a selection of these articles, although the unifying theme is not emphasised in the same way on the website.

How and why particular social groups, in a national and global context, may be under-represented or misrepresented.

Most British media companies are still dominated by white male owners, CEOs and employees which does not correspond to the mixed cultural demographics of the British population. Although equal opportunities and positive action policies have impacted on greater inclusivity, it is not equal. In an interview with Creative Review, Rhona Ezuma stated: *'When I started doing my own work I realised that there wasn't the space to tell the sort of stories I was really invested in – stories that would sometimes stem from being someone who grew up in London around so much diversity, and being Black/Nigerian/British and a woman in queer circles, who was coming to understand the multiple ways in which bodies are politicised by representation.'*⁶ THIIIRD magazine exists as a platform to tell those stories and celebrate diversity not in a

tokenistic way, but wholeheartedly.

The processes which lead media producers to make choices about how to represent events, issues, individuals and social groups.

All the representations you find will be different, surprising, pro POC, pro queer, non-binary, existing in a 'third' new transformative space. THIIIRD's representations explicitly celebrate culture, heritage and diversity. Varied social groups are selected for inclusion because they are frequently marginalised by the dominant ideologies of the mainstream. They have experienced inequalities and social and cultural deprivation, largely due to the inherited ideologies of patriarchy and colonialism. In THIIIRD, they are given a space to speak because they have something new and exciting to share.



Image by Vicky Grout / Thiiirdmagazine.co.uk

Caption: Munroe Bergdorf

There are interviews with famous women who have fought their way as pioneers and are now successful in their field. They are not included to attract their fans and sell issues

⁶ Creative Review Good Reads: Thiiird magazine embraces the intersectionality of identity by Aimee McLaughlin 11/06/2021 <https://www.creativereview.co.uk/good-reads-thiiird-magazine/>